

KINGDOM OF MEROË

Full Long-Form Script & Publish Pack

Title (vidIQ 86): How An African Queen Forced Rome To Surrender — The Lost Kingdom Of Meroe

Slot: Thursday 6 August 2026, 15:00 UK · Civilisation

Slug: 23_Kingdom_of_Meroe

Verified against OGX Supabase (qvlllknedilztozxwscj) + Meroë Research Dossier (15 sources)

Contains: Part Two narration script · 11-section publish pack · 20-scene image build sheet

OGX — KINGDOM OF MEROË — FULL LONG-FORM SCRIPT (PART TWO)

Title (locked, vidIQ 86): How An African Queen Forced Rome To Surrender — The Lost Kingdom Of Meroe

Channel: OrigineX Human Archives · **Slot:** Thursday 6 Aug 2026, 15:00 UK (civilisation)

Length target: ~35–40 min · **Tone:** authoritative, cinematic, documented · **Language:** UK English

Content type: youtube_long · **Slug:** 23_Kingdom_of_Meroe

Sourcing: OGX Supabase (verified=true) + Meroë Research Dossier (15 sources). Every major claim carries an on-screen source.

Narration conventions: plain paragraphs = VO. DIR: = visual/B-roll direction. SRC: = on-screen source citation. Q: = primary-source quote. ■ CONTESTED: = on-screen nuance flag.

CHAPTER 1 — HOOK: THE FACE BENEATH THE THRESHOLD | 00:00–01:40

[Cold open. Darkness. A single oil lamp. Slow push toward a temple doorway of packed earth and stone. Torchlight flickers on a buried bronze face looking up from beneath the floor.]

In the sands of what is now central Sudan, archaeologists dug beneath the threshold of an ancient temple — and found the severed bronze head of a Roman emperor staring up at them.

It was Augustus. The first emperor of Rome. The man who called himself the son of a god.

And someone had buried his face at the entrance of their temple — deliberately, ritually — so that every worshipper who walked in would tread the emperor of Rome underfoot, forever.

[Reveal the Meroë Head — the real artefact, British Museum. Hold on the eyes.]

The Meroë Head of Augustus — British Museum, BM 1911,0901.1. Excavated by John Garstang, 1910.

That someone was an African queen. Her kingdom was called Meroë. And this is not a story of Africa being conquered by Rome.

It is the story of the African kingdom that fought Rome — and won the peace.

[TITLE CARD — "THE LOST KINGDOM OF MEROË". OGX gold on near-black.]

CHAPTER 2 — THE KINGDOM ON THE NILE | 01:40–05:00

To understand what happened, you have to go south. Far south of the pyramids the world already knows.

[Map animation — the Nile snaking from the Mediterranean down past Egypt to the confluence of the Blue and White Niles. Marker drops between the Fifth and Sixth Cataracts.]

Between the fifth and sixth cataracts of the Nile — north of modern Khartoum — stood the royal city of Meroë. From around 270 BCE to roughly 350 CE, it was the capital of an independent African state that lasted more than six hundred years.

OGX Database — Kingdom of Meroë, c.300 BCE–350 CE. Verified.

Meroë was the late, southern flowering of a far older civilisation — the Kingdom of Kush. These were the same Nubians whose kings had once ruled all of Egypt as its 25th Dynasty. Meroë was their capital reborn, deeper in the African interior, beyond the easy reach of any Mediterranean army.

[Wide cinematic of the Meroë pyramid field at dawn — dozens of steep, narrow pyramids.]

And they built pyramids — over two hundred of them. Not copies of Egypt's. Smaller, steeper, sharper — rising at a severe seventy-degree angle where Egypt's sloped at fifty-two. A distinct African architectural tradition, unmistakably their own.

Welsby, D.A., *The Kingdom of Kush*, British Museum Press, 1996.

This was a kingdom contemporary with the entire rise of Rome — with Caesar, with Augustus, with the whole imperial century that followed. And for most of that time, it answered to no one.

CHAPTER 3 — THE QUEENS WHO RULED IN THEIR OWN NAME | 05:00–08:20

Meroë had a form of power the Roman world found almost impossible to understand.

At its centre stood two figures — a king, the *gore*, and a queen-mother, the *kandake*. And the *kandake* was not a consort in the background. She was a ruler in her own right.

[Temple relief — a female ruler at equal scale to the king, mace in hand, enemies beneath her feet.]

The Greeks and Romans Latinised the title as "Candace" — and, misunderstanding it, assumed it was the name of one woman. It was not. It was an office. A line of powerful women who governed, commissioned temples, and led armies.

OGX Database — *Kandake tradition, Kingdom of Kush*. Verified.

■ **CONTESTED:** Older scholarship treated "Candace" as a personal name. Correctly, it is a royal office held by many queens across centuries.

Amanirenas. Amanishakheto. Amanitore. These were queens who ruled with full military and political authority — centuries before any comparable European example.

OGX Database — *Amanishakheto, Kandake / Queen Regnant*. Verified.

In an ancient Mediterranean where women were written out of power almost entirely, Meroë put them at the head of the state — and onto the walls of its temples, carved at the same height as the king.

CHAPTER 4 — IRON, GOLD, AND THE ROADS TO INDIA | 08:20–11:40

Meroë was not merely surviving on the edge of the known world. It was an industrial and trading power.

[Macro of glowing charcoal furnaces; sparks; molten iron; then a slow pull back to reveal enormous black slag heaps against the desert.]

Around the city lie mountains of slag — the waste of iron smelting on a scale estimated in the hundreds of thousands of tonnes. Some scholars have compared Meroë's iron output to the great iron-producing regions of the Roman Mediterranean itself.

Shinnie & Bradley; Welsby, *The Kingdom of Kush*, 1996.

That iron armed Meroë's soldiers and worked its fields. And it travelled. Down the Nile to Egypt. East across the desert to the Red Sea, and from there to Arabia, to India — and along the same routes came silk and spices from further east still.

[Trade-route map lighting up — Nile north, Red Sea east to India, gold from the desert mines.]

Gold from the Nubian mines. Ivory and ebony from the African south. Even live animals — elephants, giraffes — carried north for the arenas of Rome. Meroë sat astride the trade of a continent, and grew rich on it.

This was the kingdom Rome would decide to test.

CHAPTER 5 — A WRITING OF THEIR OWN | 11:40–14:30

And Meroë did something only a handful of civilisations in human history have ever done. It invented its own writing.

[Close macro tracking across Meroitic cursive and hieroglyphic signs carved in stone.]

Around 200 BCE, the Meroites created the Meroitic script — the oldest indigenous writing system anywhere in Africa south of the Sahara. It had two forms: a hieroglyphic script for monuments, and a flowing cursive for everyday use.

OGX Database — "Meroitic script invention," key achievement, Kingdom of Meroë. Verified.

In 1909, the British scholar Francis Griffith cracked its sounds. We can read the twenty-three signs. We can pronounce Meroitic names and titles.

F. L. Griffith, phonetic decipherment of Meroitic, 1909.

■ **CONTESTED:** The script is read phonetically with confidence — but the underlying language is still only partly understood. Short inscriptions can be translated; long texts cannot yet be fully read. Modern work links Meroitic to the Eastern Sudanic language family.

Rilly, Claude, *Le méroïtique et sa famille linguistique*, Peeters, 2010.

So Meroë speaks to us in its own voice — a voice we can hear, and are still learning to fully understand.

CHAPTER 6 — AMANI AND THE LION GOD | 14:30–17:00

Meroë worshipped an old god and a god entirely its own.

[Torchlit temple interior; a colossal ram-headed Amani figure; then reveal a lion-headed deity in relief.]

From Egypt and the Napatan past it inherited Amun — rendered in Meroitic as *Amani* — the great state god, honoured in vast temples at Meroë and at Naqa.

But beside him stood a purely African deity: Apedemak. A lion-headed war god who never existed in the Egyptian pantheon at all.

OGX Dossier — Apedemak, indigenous Meroitic war god.

[The Lion Temple at Naqa — reliefs of Apedemak flanking king and kandake.]

At the Lion Temple of Naqa, Apedemak appears alongside the king and the queen — a distinctly Meroitic vision of divine kingship. This was not borrowed religion. It was a synthesis: the inherited and the invented, standing side by side. A civilisation confident enough to make its own gods.

CHAPTER 7 — 25 BCE: THE QUEEN STRIKES FIRST | 17:00–21:00

Then came Rome.

[Roman standards planted on the southern Egyptian frontier; legionaries; a reduced, over-confident garrison.]

In 30 BCE, Augustus annexed Egypt. Roman power now pressed directly against Meroë's northern border, in the land the Meroites had long considered theirs. And when Augustus thinned his southern garrison for a campaign in Arabia, he left that frontier exposed.

The kandake Amanirenas did not wait to be invaded.

OGX Database — Amanirenas, Kandake, Military Commander, c.40–10 BCE. Verified.

[Night. Meroitic army moving north — iron spears, war elephants, the queen at its head.]

In 25 BCE she led an army north into Roman Egypt. Her forces struck the frontier towns — Aswan, Philae, Elephantine — sacked them, took prisoners and plunder, and threw down the statues of the emperor.

Strabo, who wrote within living memory of the war, records the Meroitic queen leading the campaign in person.

Strabo, Geographica 17.1.53–54.

■ **CONTESTED:** Meroitic inscriptions name the ruler as "the kandake." The identification with Amanirenas specifically is the scholarly consensus by chronological inference — not the only possibility (Amanishakheto is an alternative). Strabo's line that she was "one-eyed" comes from a single passage and cannot be confirmed.

OGX Database — Amanirenas record, contested note.

And from the forum of Aswan, her soldiers took the bronze head of a great statue of Augustus. They carried it eight hundred miles south. And they buried it — beneath a temple threshold at Meroë — so the emperor's face would be trodden underfoot forever.

[Return to the cold-open image — the head being lowered into the earth. Full circle.]

CHAPTER 8 — THE ROMAN COUNTER-STROKE | 21:00–24:00

Augustus could not let it stand.

[Roman prefect Petronius; three legions forming column; march south into Nubia.]

He sent his prefect of Egypt, Gaius Petronius, south with a Roman army — perhaps three legions. In 24 BCE, Petronius drove into Nubia. He took the old religious capital, Napata — by then already abandoned — and burned it.

Strabo, Geographica 17.1.54; Augustus, Res Gestae 26.

But that was the limit of Rome's reach. The further south the legions marched, the longer their supply lines, the harsher the land, and the more stubborn the resistance. Petronius besieged the frontier post of Premnis. He could hold ground. He could not break Meroë.

[Roman column stalled; desert stretching endlessly ahead; Meroitic raiders shadowing the flanks.]

Amanirenas did not surrender. She kept the war alive. And slowly, a truth settled over the Roman command: this was a kingdom Rome could raid — but could not conquer.

CHAPTER 9 — THE TREATY OF SAMOS: ROME BLINKS | 24:00–27:30

So Rome did something it almost never did with an enemy who had struck first. It negotiated.

[The Greek island of Samos, 21 BCE. Meroitic envoys receiving terms directly from the emperor's court.]

In 21 BCE, Meroitic ambassadors reached Augustus himself. The result was the Treaty of Samos — and its terms were extraordinary for a people who had sacked Roman cities.

Rome pulled its frontier back to Maharraqa. Meroë was exempted from tribute. And according to the ancient sources, the empire made economic concessions — quite possibly an annual subsidy — to keep the peace.

Cassius Dio, *Roman History* 54.5; Strabo, *Geographica* 17.1.54.

■ **CONTESTED:** Whether Rome paid formal "tribute" is debated — Strabo and Dio differ on the terms. Some subsidy or trade concession is most likely; the exact status is disputed. Augustus's own *Res Gestae* mentions the Nubian campaign without admitting the unfavourable terms.

This is the single fact the history books quietly drop. Meroë is the only African kingdom of the Roman age documented to have forced Augustan Rome to make territorial concessions and waive its demand for tribute.

OGX Database — Amanirenas: "the only ruler known to have forced Rome to waive tribute demands." Verified.

The peace that followed held for nearly three hundred years.

CHAPTER 10 — THE GOLDEN AGE OF AMANITORE AND NATAKAMANI | 27:30–31:00

What Amanirenas defended, her successors made magnificent.

[Temple construction; scaffolding; masons; reliefs being carved; a kingdom at its height.]

Around the turn of the first century CE came the joint reign of King Natakamani and the kandake Amanitore — the architectural summit of the Meroitic world.

OGX Database — Amanitore, Kandake of Kush, co-ruler; temple reliefs at Naqa and Musawwarat. Verified.

They rebuilt the great Amun temple at Meroë. They raised temples at Naqa. And at Musawwarat es-Sufra they completed the Great Enclosure — the largest single architectural complex the kingdom ever built.

[Naqa reliefs — Natakamani and Amanitore carved at equal size, each smiting enemies.]

On those temple walls, king and queen appear together — carved at the same height, each shown as a warrior and a builder. A gender symmetry almost unheard of in the ancient world. This was Meroë at its most confident: rich from iron and trade, secure behind a treaty that Rome dared not break, writing in its own script, worshipping its own gods.

CHAPTER 11 — THE SLOW SUNSET | 31:00–34:00

No empire holds forever.

[Slag heaps; over-worked fields; thinning forests; a drier, harder landscape.]

From the late second century, Meroë began to decline — and the reasons were many. Centuries of intensive farming and charcoal-burning for the iron furnaces had worn the land. And far away, the

currents of trade were shifting.

Edwards, D.N., *The Nubian Past*, Routledge, 2004.

A new power was rising on the Red Sea: the Kingdom of Aksum, in the highlands of modern Ethiopia and Eritrea. As Rome routed more of its eastern trade through Aksum's ports, the wealth that had flowed up the Nile through Meroë began to flow elsewhere.

[Trade routes on the map dimming along the Nile, brightening through Aksum.]

The royal inscriptions grow fewer. The great building slows. The kingdom that had faced down Augustus was being quietly outflanked — not by an army, but by history moving on.

CHAPTER 12 — 350 CE: THE LAST BLOW | 34:00–36:30

The end, when it came, came from another African power.

[Aksumite army; King Ezana; the march down the Nile-Eritrean borderlands.]

Around 350 CE, the Aksumite king Ezana marched on Meroë.

OGX Database — King Ezana of Axum, c.300–360 CE, conqueror of Meroë c.350 CE. Verified.

We have his own words. On a great trilingual stone at Aksum — written in Ge'ez, in Sabaeen, and in Greek — Ezana records his campaign against the Noba and his subjugation of Kush.

The Ezana Stone records the Aksumite campaign against the Noba and the taking of the land of the Kasu — Kush.

The Ezana Stone, Aksum, c.350 CE, trilingual inscription.

The royal city was sacked. The Meroitic political order — six centuries of it — came to an end. In its place, over the following two centuries, rose the Christian Nubian kingdoms: Nobatia, Makuria, Alodia. The story of the Nile continued. But the Kingdom of Meroë was over.

CHAPTER 13 — WHY THIS MATTERS | 36:30–39:00

So why has almost no one heard of it?

[Slow montage — the Meroë Head; the pyramids; Meroitic script; empty museum captions.]

Here is a civilisation that lasted six hundred years. That built two hundred pyramids. That invented the oldest writing system in Africa south of the Sahara. That ran an iron industry rivalling Rome's. That was ruled, again and again, by women who commanded armies. And that forced the first emperor of Rome to sign a treaty on Meroë's terms.

Every single one of those facts is documented. None of it is myth.

■ **CONTESTED** — and we say so honestly: Meroitic is only partly translated. The "one-eyed queen" rests on one Roman line. Whether Rome paid true "tribute" is debated. We flag the uncertainties — because the core story doesn't need embellishment.

[The buried head, one last time.]

Meroë was not a footnote to Egypt. It was not a shadow of Rome. It was an African superpower that stood on its own for six centuries — and the reason you were never taught it is not that the evidence is missing. The bronze head is in a museum. The pyramids still stand. The evidence was always

there.

This is what OrigineX exists to recover: the African historical canon that was documented, and then left out.

CHAPTER 14 — CONCLUSION + CTA | 39:00–40:00

An African queen buried the face of Rome's first emperor beneath her temple floor — and made Rome pay for peace. That is not legend. That is the record.

[OGX end-card — subscribe button, next-video tile.]

If this is the history you were never taught, subscribe — OrigineX Human Archives is recovering it, one documented empire at a time. Share this with someone who thinks African history begins with the slave trade.

Next Thursday — we follow the power that finally toppled Meroë, and became one of the first Christian empires on earth: the Kingdom of Aksum.

OrigineX Human Archives · Two long-forms a week — Tuesday a person, Thursday a civilisation.

OGX KINGDOM OF MEROË — FULL PUBLISH PACK

Thursday slot — 15:00 UK — OrigineX Human Archives

1. TITLE (vidIQ scored)

WINNER (vidIQ 86 — locked, matches thumbnail + Supabase row):

How An African Queen Forced Rome To Surrender — The Lost Kingdom Of Meroe

Backups (A/B if the algorithm is sluggish in the first 24h):

- [88] She Buried A Roman Emperor's Head Under Her Doorstep — The Kingdom Of Meroe
(outscored the winner — consider swapping if CTR lags)
 - [77] The African Kingdom That Fought Rome For 300 Years — And Won
 - [—] Meroë: The African Superpower Rome Could Raid But Never Conquer
-

2. DESCRIPTION (paste into YouTube description box)

In 25 BCE an African queen led her army into Roman Egypt, sacked its frontier cities, and took the bronze head of a statue of the emperor Augustus. She carried it 800 miles south and buried it beneath a temple threshold at her capital — so that every worshipper would tread the face of Rome's first emperor underfoot, forever.

Her name was Amanirenas. Her kingdom was Meroë — the southern, Meroitic-speaking successor to the Kingdom of Kush, on the Nile in what is now central Sudan. From around 270 BCE to 350 CE it was an independent African state: over 200 pyramids, the oldest indigenous writing system in Africa south of the Sahara, an iron industry rivalling Rome's, and a line of ruling queens — the kandakes — who commanded armies in their own name.

When Augustus sent three legions south under Petronius, Rome could raid Meroë but could not conquer it. In 21 BCE the Treaty of Samos withdrew the Roman frontier, exempted Meroë from tribute, and — by the ancient sources — had Rome pay to keep the peace. It held for nearly 300 years. Meroë finally fell not to Rome but to the rising African empire of Aksum, around 350 CE.

This is the African superpower Western world-history syllabi left out.

OrigineX Human Archives — recovering the African and Afro-Asiatic historical canon.

CHAPTERS

- 00:00 The face beneath the threshold
- 01:40 The kingdom on the Nile
- 05:00 The queens who ruled in their own name
- 08:20 Iron, gold, and the roads to India
- 11:40 A writing of their own
- 14:30 Amani and the lion god
- 17:00 25 BCE — the queen strikes first
- 21:00 The Roman counter-stroke
- 24:00 The Treaty of Samos — Rome blinks

27:30 The golden age of Amanitore and Natakamani
31:00 The slow sunset
34:00 350 CE — the last blow
36:30 Why this matters
39:00 Conclusion

SOURCES

- Welsby, Derek A. — *The Kingdom of Kush: The Napatan and Meroitic Empires* (British Museum Press, 1996)
- Török, László — *The Kingdom of Kush* (Brill, 1997)
- Edwards, David N. — *The Nubian Past: An Archaeology of the Sudan* (Routledge, 2004)
- Rilly, Claude — *Le méroïtique et sa famille linguistique* (Peeters, 2010)
- Strabo, *Geographica* 17.1.53–54 · Cassius Dio, *Roman History* 54.5 · Augustus, *Res Gestae* 26
- The Meroë Head — British Museum, BM 1911,0901.1 · The Ezana Stone, Aksum, c.350 CE

RELATED FROM OGX

- Aksum: The African Empire That Outlasted Rome
- Queen Amanirenas: The One-Eyed Kandake Who Fought Augustus
- Septimius Severus: The African Emperor Who Ran Rome From Britain

SUBSCRIBE

We publish two long-forms per week — Tuesday: a person, Thursday: a civilisation. Plus daily Shorts.
\\#KingdomOfMeroe #BlackHistory #AfricanHistory #Nubia #Kush #OrigineX

3. TAGS (30, comma-separated)

Kingdom of Meroe, Meroë, Meroitic, Kingdom of Kush, Nubia, Amanirenas, kandake, Candace queen, Nubian pyramids, Meroe pyramids, Meroitic script, Apedemak, Amanitore, Natakamani, Treaty of Samos, Meroe head of Augustus, Roman Nubia war, Kush vs Rome, ancient Sudan, Nile civilisations, African empires, Black history, African history, hidden history, untold ancient history, Ezana of Axum, Nubian queens, ancient women rulers, OrigineX, OGX history

4. HASHTAGS (description top OR title field)

\\#KingdomOfMeroe #Nubia #Kush #BlackHistory #AfricanHistory #AncientAfrica #UntoldHistory #OrigineX #Amanirenas #AncientWomenRulers

5. PINNED COMMENT (post + pin within 5 min of going live)

In 25 BCE an African queen took the bronze head of a statue of the emperor Augustus and buried it under a temple doorway — so her people would walk on Rome's emperor every single day. Then Rome signed a treaty on HER terms and left.

Most ancient-history syllabi skip Meroë entirely. Why do you think that is?

Drop your answer below and I'll pin the best one.

— Joe at OGX

6. COMMUNITY POST (post 30 min before drop)

NEW VIDEO TONIGHT (Thursday 3pm UK) ■

An African kingdom on the Nile fought Rome to a standstill, forced the emperor Augustus to waive tribute, and lasted 600 years — with women at the head of its armies.

Had you heard of the Kingdom of Meroë before today?

- Yes
- No
- The name only, not the story

7. REELS / SHORTS HOOKS (cut from the long-form, post over the next 7 days)

Day	Hook + cut
Day 0 (Thu)	An African queen buried a Roman emperor's head under her doorstep. — head macro, 30s
Day 1 (Fri)	This African kingdom made ROME pay tribute. Not the other way round. — treaty scene, 35s
Day 2 (Sat)	Africa's oldest writing system isn't Egyptian. It's this. — Meroitic script macro, 40s
Day 3 (Sun)	These queens led armies 1,500 years before Europe had a female general. — kandake relief, 35s
Day 4 (Mon)	This kingdom built 200 pyramids — and they're not in Egypt. — pyramid field, 30s
Day 5 (Tue)	Augustus sent 3 legions south. They couldn't take it. — Petronius scene, 35s
Day 6 (Wed)	Why does no school history book mention Meroë? — museum caption, 40s

8. CROSS-PLATFORM POSTS

X / Twitter:

In 25 BCE an African queen sacked Roman Egypt, took the bronze head off a statue of Augustus, and buried it under her temple floor so her people would tread on Rome's emperor daily.

Then Rome signed a treaty on her terms and paid to keep the peace.

The Kingdom of Meroë. New OGX long-form: [LINK]

LinkedIn:

A note on a state that ran a 300-year strategic standoff with a superpower — and is missing from most history syllabi.

The Kingdom of Meroë (c.270 BCE–350 CE), on the Nile in modern Sudan, fought Rome under Augustus, sacked its frontier, and negotiated the Treaty of Samos (21 BCE): Rome withdrew its border and waived tribute. Meroë ran an iron industry comparable to Mediterranean producers, invented its own script, and was repeatedly led by ruling queens — the kandakes. It outlasted the war by nearly three centuries.

New OrigineX long-form drops Thursday 15:00 UK: [\[LINK\]](#)

Facebook:

NEW on OrigineX Human Archives — Thursday 15:00 UK.

The African kingdom that fought Rome to a standstill, made the emperor Augustus waive tribute, invented Africa's oldest indigenous writing, and was led by warrior queens — for 600 years.

This is the ancient African superpower your school history book never mentioned. [\[LINK\]](#)

Instagram:

25 BCE. An African queen named Amanirenas takes the bronze head from a statue of Augustus and buries it beneath a temple threshold at Meroë — so Rome's emperor is trodden underfoot forever.

Her kingdom made Rome sign a treaty and withdraw.

Full long-form on the OrigineX channel — link in bio.

[\#KingdomOfMeroe](#) [#Nubia](#) [#BlackHistory](#) [#AncientHistory](#) [#UntoldHistory](#) [#OrigineX](#)

9. THUMBNAIL CHECKLIST

- Subject: Nubian kandake in three-quarter profile — dark-to-brown skin, gold kandake regalia, beaded collar; OR the bronze Meroë Head with sand falling away.
- Backdrop: Meroë pyramid field silhouette at sunset, gold-on-dark (OGX house style).
- Text overlay: **SHE MADE ROME PAY.** in OGX gold.
- OGX logo bottom-right.
- Tested at 320×180 mobile preview — face + text readable.
- CTR-test against backup variant: the buried head of Augustus, macro.
- Authentic-representation rule: visibly African/Nubian features, region-accurate Meroitic dress — no European-ised or generic "ancient" look.

10. SCHEDULE NOTES

- Drop date/time: **Thursday 6 August 2026, 15:00 UK (14:00 UTC)**
- Cadence slot: Thursday = CIVILISATION
- Privacy: Private until scheduled go-live
- Category: Education (id 27)
- Default language: en-GB
- Notify subscribers: Yes
- Made for kids: No
- End screen: Aksum + Amanirenas + subscribe button
- Cards: Aksum card at ~34:00 (the power that toppled Meroë), subscribe card at ~27:00

11. UPLOAD CHECKLIST

- ☐ FINAL.mp4 rendered (render_ogx.py 23_Kingdom_of_Meroe) and length-checked against audio (~3343s)
- ☐ THUMBNAIL.png exported at 1280×720, under 2MB
- ☐ Title pasted from Section 1 (winner)
- ☐ Description pasted from Section 2 (chapters re-timed to the final cut)
- ☐ Tags pasted from Section 3
- ☐ Visibility set to Private + publish_at = 2026-08-06 14:00 UTC
- ☐ Pinned comment drafted (Section 5)
- ☐ Community post scheduled 30 min before drop (Section 6)
- ☐ Cross-platform posts queued (Section 8)
- ☐ Shorts batch submitted (7 clips, Section 7)
- ☐ Supabase content_ideas row → status = 'ready_to_publish'
- ☐ _pipeline_state.json updated (render_ogx.py does this automatically)

Generated by OGX pipeline — verified against Supabase (project qvlllknedilztozxwscj) + Meroë Research Dossier (15 sources).

OGX KINGDOM OF MEROË — 20-SCENE IMAGE BUILD SHEET

Feeds the render pipeline: save as
02_images_inbox/23_Kingdom_of_Meroe/01_scene.png ... 20_scene.png (+ THUMBNAIL.png).

Each scene image is on screen ~2.8 min (audio ÷ 20) with a slow Ken Burns zoom (render_ogx.py).

■ **LOCKED art-direction suffix — append VERBATIM to every prompt**

cinematic, dramatic volumetric lighting, historically accurate Meroitic / Nubian Kingdom of Kush, visibly African/Nubian people with dark-to-brown skin and African features in region-accurate Meroitic dress (white cotton wraps with coloured woven borders, beaded broad collars, gold kandake regalia, shaved or short natural hair, hoop earrings), Nile-desert setting, steep 70° Nubian pyramids, rich earth-and-gold palette, film grain, shallow depth of field, epic scale, museum-documentary realism, 16:9

Representation is non-negotiable: Nubian/Kushite people, dark-to-brown skin, Meroitic dress and regalia — never European-ised, never generic "ancient Egypt". Kandakes are depicted as full, powerful, often fuller-figured women per the temple reliefs.

#	Chapter	Prompt (before the locked suffix)
01	Hook	Extreme close-up of an ancient bronze head of a Roman emperor half-buried face-up in packed earth beneath a torch-lit temple doorway, sand falling away from the eyes
02	Hook→title	Wide aerial of the Nile at dawn winding through desert, the Meroë pyramid field of dozens of steep narrow pyramids catching first gold light
03	Kingdom on the Nile	Map-style cinematic of the Nile from the Mediterranean south past Egypt to a glowing marker between the fifth and sixth cataracts, north of modern Khartoum
04	Kingdom on the Nile	Ground-level hero shot of the steep 70° Meroitic royal pyramids, a Nubian priest walking between them at golden hour
05	The queens	Temple relief come to life: a Nubian kandake (queen-mother) at equal scale to the king, mace raised, richly robed, gold regalia, enemies beneath her feet
06	The queens	Portrait of a powerful Meroitic kandake enthroned, dark-brown skin, elaborate beaded collar and gold crown, attendants around her
07	Iron & trade	Interior of a Meroitic iron-smelting workshop, glowing low-bowl charcoal furnaces, Nubian ironworkers pouring molten metal, sparks, huge slag heaps outside

#	Chapter	Prompt (before the locked suffix)
08	Iron & trade	Bustling Meroitic riverside market: gold, ivory, ebony, live exotic animals, caravans loading for the Red Sea, Nubian traders
09	Writing of their own	Macro of Meroitic hieroglyphic and cursive script carved and painted on a sandstone temple wall, a Nubian scribe's hand tracing the signs
10	Amani & lion god	Torch-lit temple interior with a colossal ram-headed Amani (Amun) statue and, beside it, a fierce lion-headed Apedemak deity in carved relief
11	Amani & lion god	The Lion Temple at Naqa exterior at dusk, reliefs of Apedemak flanking the king and kandake, worshippers approaching
12	25 BCE strike	Night march: a Meroitic army moving north with iron spears, archers and war elephants, the kandake Amanirenas leading at the front on a chariot
13	25 BCE strike	Meroitic warriors storming a Roman frontier town (Aswan), toppling a marble statue of Augustus, torches and dust
14	25 BCE strike	Meroitic soldiers carrying a large bronze Roman imperial head across desert dunes on a litter, long caravan behind, dramatic sky
15	Roman counter-stroke	Roman prefect Petronius and three legions in column marching south into harsh Nubian desert, standards raised, supply lines stretching to the horizon
16	Treaty of Samos	Diplomatic scene on the Greek island of Samos, 21 BCE: dignified Nubian Meroitic envoys in white-and-gold receiving terms before a Roman imperial court
17	Golden age	Grand temple construction at Musawwarat es-Sufra: scaffolding, Nubian masons carving reliefs, King Natakamani and Kandake Amanitore inspecting, kingdom at its height
18	Slow sunset	Melancholy wide of worn fields, thinning trees and cooling iron furnaces at dusk, a drier harder landscape, trade caravans diverting east away from the Nile
19	Fall to Aksum	Aksumite army of King Ezana descending on the city of Meroë c.350 CE, smoke rising over the pyramids, the trilingual Ezana Stone in foreground
20	Why this matters / end	Reverent museum-lit final shot of the bronze Meroë Head beside a silhouette of the Nubian pyramids, gold-on-black, evoking recovered memory

THUMBNAIL.png — Nubian kandake in three-quarter profile (dark-to-brown skin, gold regalia, beaded collar) against a Meroë pyramid-field sunset silhouette, OGX gold overlay text "SHE MADE

ROME PAY.", OGX logo bottom-right. 1280×720, <2MB. (Backup variant: the buried bronze head macro.)